

Thursday, 21 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

23° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 12°

MANCHESTER

Heavy drizzle

20° 12°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

By-elections to replace former MPs set for next month.

Stephen Flynn and Stephen Gethins stood down as MPs after being elected to Holyrood earlier this month

POLITICS · UK

2

'I made Venezuela Fury's 40ft wedding train - it was too big for my workshop'.

Lancashire seamstress Emily Green had to use a church hall to lay out and hand sew the 40ft (12m) train.

UK · NEWS

3

'Ghost brokers' targeting 17 to 25 year-olds with fake car insurance online.

The finance watchdog warns bogus brokers are selling fake car insurance through social media.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Jackson Pollock painting sells for record \$181m at auction.

The Abstract Expressionist's Number 7A, 1948 painting is now his most expensive artwork ever sold at auction.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

The British White Lotus? A group trip goes wrong in BBC drama Two Weeks in August.

The cast of the new BBC drama say the series explores what happens when a 'group holiday goes wrong'.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

In pictures: Celebrity style meets garden design at Chelsea 2026.

Designers from around the world showcase their gardens at the RHS Chelsea Flower Show.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 GB's Samuel one win from French Open breakthrough.**
Britain's Toby Samuel is one win away from a first Grand Slam singles appearance after beating David Goffin in French Open qualifying.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Southampton hit out at 'disproportionate' Spygate punishment.**
Southampton say they have appealed against their removal from the Championship play-offs for spying as it is "manifestly disproportionate to every previous sanction in the history of the English game".
SPORT · UK
- 3 Rousey v Carano sets record as 17m watch MMA event.**
Ronda Rousey's return generated a huge 17 million in audience figures on Netflix.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Tottenham lose at Chelsea to take relegation fight to final day.**
Tottenham miss the opportunity to secure Premier League safety after they're beaten 2-1 by Chelsea at Stamford Bridge, meaning their fight against relegation will go down to the final day, with the club sitting two points above the bottom three.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 2 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 3 The most-Googled DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 4 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 5 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 6 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 7 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 69% of Brits do THIS as soon as they get in from work. What?
ANSWER: TAKE THEIR TROUSERS OFF AND PUT PYJAMA BOTTOMS ON.

Q 39% of us have done THIS in a supermarket trolley aisle. What?
ANSWER: HAD A FULL DOMESTIC ARGUMENT.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**
Talk-back: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right? Or the quickest you DID like someone?
- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**
Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Travel.** A small Welsh railway station — Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogoch — sells more platform-ticket souvenirs than any other UK station.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Norfolk B&B has started offering a 'no chit-chat' room for guests who want to skip breakfast small talk, marked with a polite door card and a £10 surcharge.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A blue whale's tongue alone weighs as much as an elephant.
- Octopuses can taste with their suckers.
- Wales has more castles per square mile than any other country in the world.
- Bananas grow upside down.
- Your nose can detect over a trillion different scents.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way.
- A snail can sleep for three years at a time.

On this day

Day 141 of the year, 224 days left in 2026. Today Afro-Colombian Day (Colombia); Christian feast day: Blessed Adílio Daronch and Manuel Gómez González; Christian feast day: Blessed Franz Jägerstätter; Christian feast day: Earliest day on which Corpus Christi can fall, while June 24 is the latest; held on Thursday after Trinity Sunday (often locally moved to Sunday). (Roman Catholic Church). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Rosalind Plowright, English soprano
- 1992 — Hutch Dano, American actor
- 1973 — Noel Fielding, English comedian, musician and television presenter
- 1978 — Max B, American rapper and songwriter
- 1985 — Kano, English rapper, producer, and actor
- 1957 — Judge Reinhold, American actor and producer
- 1948 — Elizabeth Buchan, English author and critic
- 1947 — Bill Champlin, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1994 — The Democratic Republic of Yemen unsuccessfully attempts to secede from the Republic of Yemen; a war breaks out.
- 2000 — Nineteen people are killed in a plane crash in Wilkes-Barre, Pennsylvania.
- 2012 — A bus accident near Himara, Albania kills 13 people and injures 21 others.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2010 — JAXA, the Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency, launches the solar-sail spacecraft IKAROS aboard an H-IIA rocket. The vessel would make a Venus flyby late in the year.
- 2012 — A bus accident near Himara, Albania kills 13 people and injures 21 others.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2001 — French Taubira law is enacted, officially recognizing the Atlantic slave trade and slavery as crimes against humanity.
- 1976 — Twenty-nine people are killed in the Yuba City bus disaster in Martinez, California.

- 2012 — A suicide bombing kills more than 120 people in Sanaa, Yemen.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 142 of the year, 223 days left in 2026. Today Abolition Day (Martinique); Aromanian National Day (marginal, celebration on May 23 is more common); Christian feast day: Castus and Emilius; Christian feast day: Fulk. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Michael Kelly, American actor
- 1939 — Paul Winfield, American actor (died 2004)
- 1946 — George Best, Northern Irish footballer and manager (died 2005)
- 1940 — Kieth Merrill, American filmmaker
- 1928 — John Mackenzie, Scottish director and producer (died 2011)
- 1953 — Paul Mariner, English footballer, coach, and manager (died 2021)
- 1938 — Susan Strasberg, American actress (died 1999)
- 1974 — Sean Gunn, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2017 — United States President Donald Trump visits the Church of the Holy Sepulchre in Jerusalem and becomes the first sitting U.S. president to visit the Western Wall.
- 1994 — A worldwide trade embargo against Haiti goes into effect to punish its military rulers for not reinstating the country's ousted elected leader, Jean-Bertrand Aristide.
- 1972 — Over 400 women in Derry, Northern Ireland attack the offices of Sinn Féin following the shooting by the Irish Republican Army of a young British soldier on leave.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2010 — Air India Express Flight 812, a Boeing 737 crashes over a cliff upon landing at Mangalore, India, killing 158 of 166 people on board, becoming the deadliest crash involving a Boeing 737 until the crash of Lion Air Flight 610.
- 1998 — A U.S. federal judge rules that U.S. Secret Service agents can be compelled to testify before a grand jury concerning the Lewinsky scandal involving President Bill Clinton.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		